Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · BUILD · Spring 2 Week 3 · Monday 8 March 2027 · P5

Lesson

Three parts of a story

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Weekly outcome

Sequence a short drama with a group.

Today I can

I can show the start, change and end.

I can use my part or cue.

I can keep my own choice in my arts log.

Prepare

For three or four pupils: books or arts logs and pencils.

A clear personal space for each pupil, or seats with safe room for hand gestures.

Three cue words read from the activity card: Start, Next, End. No real den, sticks, boxes or props.

Keep the three-part sequence and individual log ready for the next lesson. No camera or device is required.

Cover route

Read The new den from the Starter stage. Assign accessible roles without requiring speech. Model three hand poses, then let the group choose and rehearse three poses in order. Use Start, Next, End cues. Keep a dated three-part sketch or adult observation plus each pupil's own confirmed contribution. Keep the sequence for the next lesson.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: We will make a tiny story in three parts. You can be a mover, a voice or a director. You may sit and use your hands. We will not touch, run or build a real den. Show an open hand to stop.

Look for: Each pupil confirms an accessible role and the stop cue. Adult checks clear space.

Fallback: Offer two roles: show a hand pose or tell the adult which pose to show.

Check and response: A pupil may direct one pose while another pupil performs it. That is a valid role if the choice is the pupil's.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: I will read three parts. Hold up one finger for the start, two for the change and three for the end. Which part shows the new plan? We can change a plan and still tell a good story.

Look for: Pupils identify the ending as the small den and notice the space changes.

Fallback: Read only the start and end. Ask the pupil to point to the one that shows the new plan.

Check and response: The small den is the end. The small space is the change. The group changes its plan rather than trying to force a big den into the space.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: Watch me tell the story with hands only. First I point wide. Next I hold my hands close to show the space is small. I pause and say, Can we change it? Last I show a small roof with my hands. Now I mix up the order. Does the new plan still come last? Tell me which pose to move.

Look for: The adult contrasts ordered and mixed beats. A pupil identifies or directs a correction. Check understanding before group practice.

Fallback: Use just three spoken cues and hand shapes at the desk. The pupil can hold up one, two or three fingers.

Check and response: Start then change then end makes the new plan clear. If the small-den pose comes first, the audience may not see why the plan changes.

We do 6 minutes

Say: Let us use one idea from each person. A mover may show a pose, a voice may give a cue, and a director may choose the pose. With four pupils two can share a pose role. Everyone keeps their own space. Try our three parts. Can we see the small space before the new den?

Look for: Each pupil offers or confirms a creative choice. Group holds three poses in order and uses an agreed cue.

Fallback: Adult reads the cues while pupils choose hand shapes. A pupil may direct the adult to show their chosen shape.

Check and response: A close hand shape can show the small space. A small roof shape may show the new den. Other clear, safe choices are valid.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: For the first three minutes choose roles and poses. Rehearse for four minutes. For three minutes test a cue or change a pose so the story is clear. Use the last four minutes to keep a three-part sketch or adult-written record and your own choice. No actual den is built. Ask for a pause if you need one.

Look for: Group performs or directs an ordered three-part story. Each pupil has an identifiable contribution and keeps an individual record.

Fallback: Use the supplied story exactly, with hand poses and an adult caller. The pupil chooses one pose or cue and confirms the three-part record.

Check and response: Example only: I chose close hands for the change. Our start is wide space, our change is small space, and our end is a small den. A pupil may use their own safe ending if it follows the change.

Review 5 minutes

Say: The watcher describes the order, not how brave anyone was. Say I saw ... first, then ... . Maker, confirm or correct that account. Use the final two minutes to settle and store the sequence for tomorrow. No public performance is required.

Look for: Audience identifies order and pupil confirms one choice to retain. Record honest uncertainty where the change was not clear.

Fallback: Adult watches one hand sequence privately and asks which pose the pupil wants to keep.

Check and response: Useful feedback: I saw the wide space first and the small den last. A useful next step: hold the middle pose a little longer.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: I can write your words and read them back. Tell me if I have got your idea right. Keep your own choice, not my sample. Write or confirm today's date and the help you used.

Look for: Dated log records individual contribution, sequence and a real next step.

Fallback: Pupil points to one of the three poses; adult records the confirmed choice and what the pupil directed.

Check: Example only: My role was director. I chose the small roof. Next time I will hold the change pose longer.

Evidence and review

Retain a dated sequence sketch or cue record, a brief adult observation of the real performance or rehearsal, and each pupil's own confirmed arts-log words. Record the contribution, change and support actually used. A photograph or recording is optional under local consent procedures. Never enter a teacher model as pupil work.

Misconceptions

A still pose cannot tell a story - Three clear poses in order can show a start, change and end.

Everyone must speak - A silent pose or a pupil-directed adult pose is a valid contribution.

The group must build a real den - All objects and places are imagined. Show the idea with safe gestures.

Questions

foundation: Which part comes first?

middle: Which cue helps the next part start?

higher: How does the last pose show the new plan has worked?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Check a clear personal space before any movement. Walk only; no running, lifting, falling, climbing, throwing or actual building. Keep all imagined props imaginary. Use an agreed open-hand stop cue. Do not move another pupil or their chair.

Emotional and sensory access

Use invented situations. No personal accounts, surprise noise, touch, contact, shouting or forced eye contact. Offer seated movement, silent gesture, narrator or director roles. Pupils may share with a trusted adult only. Agree a calm place and a return cue before starting.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Show one story beat at a time. Rehearse three or four beats with concrete cue words. Model the first pose, then fade the adult lead. Check the pupil can point to the next beat.

Communication And Interaction: Offer pointing, signing, a narrator line, directing or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ... because ... and First ... next ... last ... .

Semh: Keep the event fictional and low stakes. Agree roles with pupils. Allow a pause, role change or private audience. Praise a specific contribution rather than confidence or compliance.

Sensory And Physical: Perform from a chair, use hands only or direct an adult. Avoid unexpected sound and touch. Ensure personal space. A silent cue is valid.

Eal: Plan in any language. Pair story cues with gestures. Accept oral rehearsal or a labelled sketch. Check the intended story order rather than accent or spelling.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. Each lesson is complete without the optional GROW next level stretch. Keep records for the award; these lessons alone do not complete or certify it.

Resilience can include pausing, asking for help, changing a plan and trying a manageable next step. It does not mean hiding feelings, tolerating harm or continuing through pain.